Holden Holden Barina (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/2

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Holden | Model: Holden Barina | Australian Market Years: 1985-2018
Vehicle Type: Hatchback / Sedan / Convertible | Segment: Light / Subcompact | Locally Built: No
Assembly Plants (AU): Imported (Kosai & Hamamatsu, Japan, MB/ML/MF/MH), Imported (Zaragoza, Spain, SB/XC)

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

For over 33 years across six generations, the Holden Barina was Australia’s quintessential ligh
t car. Introduced in February 1985 as the MB Barina (a badge-engineered Suzuki Cultus made unfo
rgettable by poet Pam Ayres’ commercial: ’Beep beep, Barina!’), the model transitioned through
the ML, MF, and MH series. In 1994, Holden pivoted to GM Europe with the SB Barina (Opel Corsa
B), creating an Australian youth lifestyle phenomenon that produced the cult Barina GSi (1.6L 1
6V twin-cam). The 2001 XC Barina won Wheels Car of the Year 2001. Sourcing moved to GM Daewoo i
n 2005 with the value-focused TK, while the final 2011-2018 TM Barina featured GM’s global Gamm
a II platform, culminating in the sporty Barina RS powered by a 103 kW 1.4L Turbo engine.

The SB Barina revolutionized Australia’s light car market, introducing European chassis feel, s
tandard driver airbag options, and vibrant youth-oriented exterior color palettes. It dominated
private light car sales for years, while the hot hatch Barina GSi became an enduring grassroot
s motorsport and hillclimb favorite.

SERIES / GENERATION: MB-ML (MB / ML Barina) [1985-1988]

Body Styles: 5-door hatchback | ANCAP: None
First-generation Barina. Suzuki Cultus base, celebrated in iconic Pam Ayres television advertis
ing. Super-economical 1.3L four-cylinder engine.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Suzuki-G13A: 1.3L (1324cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 54.0 kW / 103.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Barina Hatch: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $7890-$8890, Fuel=6.2L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Barina Hatch | Hatchback | Suzuki-G13A | 5-speed manual | FWD | 54.0kW/103.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: SB (SB Barina) [1994-2001]

Body Styles: 3-door hatchback, 5-door hatchback, 2-door convertible | ANCAP: 3
Transition to GM Europe Opel Corsa B. Phenomenal sales success among Australian youth; introduc
ed vibrant colors, European ergonomics, and the famous twin-cam Barina GSi hot hatch.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- ECOTEC-1.4-C14SE: 1.4L (1389cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 60.0 kW / 114.0 Nm
- ECOTEC-1.6-C16XE: 1.6L (1598cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 78.0 kW / 150.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- City: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $13990-$15490, Fuel=6.8L/100km
- GSi: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $21990-$23490, Fuel=7.4L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* City | Hatchback | ECOTEC-1.4-C14SE | 5-speed manual | FWD | 60.0kW/114.0Nm
* GSi | Hatchback | ECOTEC-1.6-C16XE | 5-speed manual | FWD | 78.0kW/150.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: TM (TM Barina) [2011-2018]

Holden Holden Barina (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 2/2

Body Styles: 5-door hatchback, 4-door sedan | ANCAP: 5

Motorcycle-inspired digital gauge cluster, 5-star ANCAP safety across the range, MyLink touch i
nfotainment, and the warm hatch Barina RS with 103 kW 1.4L Turbo.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- ECOTEC-1.6-F16D4: 1.6L (1598cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 85.0 kW / 155.0 Nm
- Turbo-1.4-LUJ: 1.4L (1364cc) Inline4 (Turbocharged, Petrol) | 103.0 kW / 200.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- CD: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=5-speed manual, 6-speed automatic, AUD $15990-$18190, Fuel=6.8L/100km
- RS: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=6-speed manual, 6-speed automatic, AUD $20990-$23190, Fuel=6.5L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* CD | Hatchback | ECOTEC-1.6-F16D4 | 5-speed manual | FWD | 85.0kW/155.0Nm
* RS | Hatchback | Turbo-1.4-LUJ | 6-speed manual | FWD | 103.0kW/200.0Nm